



ADRIANA ZEHBRAUSKAS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

On weekends, the arms dealers known as J.M. and El Flaco, each of them too young to legally buy beer, target-shoot in the desert.

Punishment for 7 Cornell Men: ‘Reflection Papers’ to Expulsion

This article is by Sharon Otterman, Hurubie Meko and Debra Kamin.

The lightest punishment called for writing a paper and completing training. The most severe was expulsion from the school.

After a woman attending Cornell University accused seven fraternity members of sexually assaulting her in 2024, the university convened a closed proceeding to determine what had occurred and whether those men should face discipline.

Since then, the sanctions imposed on each of the men, and the reasoning behind those decisions, have remained secret. The school

Summaries Show How Blame Was Assigned

has said little.

But detailed summaries of the punishments obtained by The New York Times provide the first look at how Cornell administrators apportioned blame for the alcohol and drug-fueled gathering that the woman has said left her shattered and degraded.

Two of the fraternity members were expelled. Another, who had already graduated, was barred from campus. Two more were sus-

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‘As Long as I Make My Money’: U.S. Teens Get Guns to Cartels

By PAULINA VILLEGAS

PHOENIX — They are too young to buy a beer and barely old enough to drive, yet these four teenage boys have already found their way into the criminal under-

world. On weekends, they drive into the Sonoran Desert outside Phoenix. I watched them line up AR-15s and AK-style rifles against their cars, pose for photographs and spend the afternoon shooting targets. At night, they head to parties, smoke pot and scroll endlessly through their social media feeds.

These teenagers are part of a growing network of American

‘Phoenix Boys’ Manage a Pipeline to Mexico

high school students and young adults who are helping to arm some of Mexico’s most powerful, violent cartels, according to U.S. officials and trafficking experts who are tracking the trend. They source weapons like handguns and high-caliber rifles, and sell them almost exclusively to cartel operatives based in the United States, the teenagers said.

In repeated interviews, four weapons traffickers ages 16 to 19

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Deal Meshes Russian Oil, Ukraine and Trump Allies

Witkoff, Kushner and Putin Discussed Sale of Lukoil Assets During Peace Talks

By ANTON TROIANOVSKI and ERIC LIPTON

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration’s talks with Russia about ending the war in Ukraine have expanded to include a multi-billion-dollar oil deal that would benefit Middle Eastern business executives with ties to the two main U.S. negotiators, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner.

The deal, which is contingent on approval from the U.S. government and the Kremlin, is for a sprawling set of oil fields, refineries and gas stations around the world owned by Lukoil, one of Russia’s biggest energy companies.

The leading group seeking the deal includes an American investor, Todd Boehly, who has donated \$2 million to President Trump’s political causes; two Middle Eastern groups that have done business with Mr. Kushner or Mr. Witkoff’s family; and an arm of the U.S. government itself.

The monthslong negotiations, which were described by eight people familiar with them, shed new light on Mr. Trump’s latest approach to settling a four-year war that has killed hundreds of thousands. The people spoke on condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the negotiations.

There is no indication that Mr. Kushner or Mr. Witkoff themselves stand to profit. But the pending deal represents a striking intermingling of personal business ties with geopolitics, even for an administration that has regularly dismissed concerns about potential conflicts of interest.

President Vladimir V. Putin of Russia brought up the deal when he met with Mr. Witkoff and Mr. Kushner at the Kremlin on Sept. 5, according to three people familiar with the meeting. Mr. Putin proposed it get done as a way of showing Russians that they can do business with the United States, according to one of the people.

The Americans responded that they would work on it, the person said, seeing it as a way to build good will with the Kremlin while

also lowering global energy prices. But the deal would also be lucrative for the buyers: U.S. approval for the sale would release the assets from American sanctions, instantly increasing their value.

In Moscow, the decision on the deal is widely seen as Mr. Putin’s to make, even though Lukoil is technically a private company. The upshot is that the giant transaction, involving assets as varied as oil fields in Cameroon, refineries in Europe and gas stations in New Jersey, comes down to Mr. Putin and Mr. Trump.

Mr. Trump has been promoting the promise of business deals with Russia since early last year, describing the country as a “tremendous opportunity.” The deal again brings Mr. Trump’s World Liberty Financial cryptocurrency company — co-founded by Mr. Witkoff — into focus. One of the investors in the Lukoil deal is a part owner of World Liberty.

Mr. Witkoff and Mr. Kushner, who have traveled repeatedly to Russia for meetings with Mr. Putin, have argued that the potential to rebuild economic ties with

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MIKHAIL METZEL/SPUTNIK, VIA REUTERS
Steve Witkoff with Vladimir V. Putin in Moscow last month.

FADING BOUNDARY A plan to host a summit at a Trump golf club has elicited scant protest. PAGE A5



PHOTOGRAPHS BY MICHELLE GUSTAFSON FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Philadelphia’s first parallel parking competition crowned Mario Zucca, middle, and awarded him a trophy: a piece of sidewalk curb.

Game of Inches for Parallel Parkers, Where Waymos Can Get Lost

By CAMPBELL ROBERTSON

PHILADELPHIA — As more and more daily tasks are taken over by the machines, a newfound appreciation has emerged for certain displays of human art and mastery. We speak, today, of parallel parking.

On Saturday afternoon in Philadelphia, before a panel of judges and a crowd of hundreds, 14 residents took turns angling into tight spaces in the city’s first parallel

parking championship. Some of the contestants, like a city bus driver, were professionals, while others were in it for the love of the game. But none were particularly humble when it came to parking.

“I have a parking Instagram,” boasted Missy Philips, 35, a high school Spanish teacher who indeed has an account dedicated to photos of the tight spots she has parked in.

The event was organized principally by Adam Wodka, 42, the self-

styled commissioner of the Philadelphia Parallel Parking Association. He and a friend had been discussing the frustration of nailing a parallel parking job, slipping immaculately between two bumpers and realizing that no one was around to see it.

“It’s good to share,” Mr. Wodka said.

Parallel parking competitions appear to have originated in Pittsburgh. Dan Leber, 38, a general contractor, held the first contest

there in 2021, measuring each contestant’s attempt by time and distance from the curb, with adjustments for the size of the car. The Pittsburgh competition remains a proudly D.I.Y. affair, with entry open to all and no sponsorships. So far, more than 600 people have taken part.

Mr. Leber, who says next year’s contest may be his last, does not disqualify people for using backup cameras. But truly gifted parkers,

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A.I. Appraises Risk of Getting Breast Cancer

By RONI CARYN RABIN

Starting Thursday, women across the United States will be able to find out their risk of developing breast cancer in the near future with the help of an A.I. tool that examines a single recent mammogram.

Everlywell, a digital health company, announced it would now offer patients nationwide access to Clairity Breast, an A.I. tool approved by the Food and Drug Administration last year to predict a woman’s five-year risk of breast cancer based on imaging. The test, which was previously available only at select locations in Massachusetts and Colorado, will cost \$249. It is not covered by insurance.

Doctors use mammograms to detect the presence of cancer, sometimes with the help of A.I. models that can read the images. But Clairity’s software uses the scans for a different purpose: predicting the risk of developing cancer and providing a probability score that reports the patient’s future risk in the form of a percentage, from zero to 100.

That score, which doctors should consider along with other clinical information like family and patient medical history and other risk factors, could aid in efforts to detect cancers earlier,

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Justices Brace For Disputes From Election

By ANN E. MARIMOW and ABBIE VANSICKLE

WASHINGTON — At a public appearance this spring, Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. insisted, as he regularly does, that members of the Supreme Court are not “political actors.”

Yet with the court’s new term beginning Monday, scarcely a month before the closely watched midterms, the court may be unable to avoid getting uncomfortably pulled into electoral politics.

With partisans on both sides primed for potential election challenges, lawsuits to settle hotly contested elections could end up before the court, potentially with the control of Congress at stake. They would land on top of an already packed docket of cases on culture war issues and President Trump’s agenda that were selected by the justices to be heard from the thousands of petitions they receive each year.

The result could be another consequential and controversial span on the bench for the justices, even as their public poll numbers have dipped and elected leaders and candidates, particularly in the insurgent wing of the Democratic Party, have called for an overhaul of the court.

The court “knows what an extraordinary politicized moment

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INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Loving A.I. Too Much

China has encouraged its citizens to embrace artificial intelligence, but now the government worries over growing signs of overreliance. PAGE A4

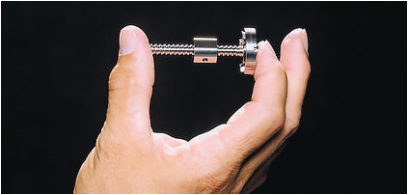
New Flares Amid U.S.-Iran War

Turmoil in the Middle East deepened as Yemen announced a military campaign against the Houthi militia. PAGE A6

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Opened Doors for Picasso

Eugenia Errázuriz, who moved from Chile to Paris, supported Stravinsky and other artists. Overlooked. PAGE B6



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Defense Turns on This Metal

As the Trump administration aims to increase the production of munitions, these screws are hard to source. PAGE B1

Why So Dystopian?

100 Zeros, a Google-partnered venture into Hollywood, will promote a brighter view of new technologies. PAGE B1

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Diesel Prices Squeeze Truckers

With fill-ups topping \$1,000, some long-distance drivers are parking their rigs or staying on the road for months while they hope for a reprieve. PAGE A11

Democrats Try to Widen Field

Dr. Annie Andrews, a candidate for Senate in South Carolina, is stirring hope that the party can win a seat in a Republican stronghold. PAGE A12

Deadly Shooting at Block Party

Two men were killed and 35 people were injured in an assault in Vienna, Ga., officials said. No arrests had been made as of Sunday afternoon. PAGE A14



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Faith, Love and Action

Fatherhood helped shape the film “Your Mother Your Mother Your Mother,” starring Mahershala Ali, above. PAGE C1

The Display That Wasn’t

Robert Lazzarini’s works from his Venice Biennale proposal can be seen at the MassArt Art Museum. PAGE C5

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At 54, He’s Still a Yankees Ace

Andy Pettitte, a five-time champion who retired in 2013, is a mentor to the star pitcher Cam Schlichter. PAGE D1

30 Reasons for N.B.A. Hype

Why each of the league’s teams should be excited for the season, which is only two weeks away. PAGE D4

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Karine Jean-Pierre

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